Day 5: Practice Tasks for Your Project

Task 1. Find Your Investor - NOT READY FOR INVESTORS

According to today's lecture materials, finding the right investors is not about getting a "yes" from anyone. It is about finding people who understand your space, believe in your team, and want to help you grow.

Here is an example of a simple research pipeline:

1. **Find similar companies** - use Crunchbase, PitchBook, or CB Insights to find startups similar to yours.
2. **See who invested in them** - look at their pre-seed and seed rounds; note which investors led and which followed.
3. **Check current activity** - check their recent portfolio. Do they still invest in similar deals?
4. **Build your target list** - create a list of 15-20 investors who are the best fit.

Then, complete the following table (mention at least 5 investors, although a full list of 15-20 is preferable):

Potential Investor	**Why this one?**	**How are you going to reach out?** *Try to find the way for warm introduction*
Overall status: Not ready	I still need to collect some real user feedback for my product, and metrics that show some kind tractions	.

Future potential investors: **Brighteye Ventures**	VC firm focused on early-stage EdTech.	Attend their annual **Brighteye Live** event in London; their Sidekick community newsletter has a subscriber list of 13,000+ founders and operators — engage publicly and you'll meet portfolio founders who can intro you
Emerge Education	Focused on learning space and future of work, specialist on early stage funding.	Connect with one on of their venture partners on LinkedIn, build a relationship, and ask for an internal intro to the partners
Sparkmind.vc	Nordic VC focused on learning sector. K-12, higher and secondary	Connect with founder in their portfolio on Linkedin.

Task 2. Elevator Pitch - NOT READY FOR INVESTORS

Although this task may seem very similar to the Conversation Pitch from the Day 4 materials, the main difference between them is the target audience - this time, you are addressing investors instead of customers. Because of that, the focus and structure should be different.

Recommended structure:

1. **Problem** - state the problem in concrete terms; make it personal and specific.
2. **Solution and Proof** - explain what you built and why it works; include one quick proof point.
3. **The Ask** - state what you are raising and what it unlocks.

Elevator pitch building pipeline:

1. **Write a long version** - do not edit yet, put everything on paper, aim for 200-300 words.
2. **Cut it in half** - remove anything that is not essential, get down to 100-150 words.

3. **Cut it again** - now be ruthless, remove every word that does not carry weight, aim for 60-80 words.
4. **Test it out loud** - say it out loud from start to finish. Time yourself - it should take between 45 and 60 seconds. Listen carefully. Does it sound clear? Or does it feel awkward or forced?
5. **Test it on real people** - share it with five people using the "Is it just me?" test. Refine based on what you hear.

Write down the final version of your elevator pitch script below:

…

Task 3. Full Investor Pitch - NOT READY FOR INVESTORS

This is the most complete version of your project presentation. However, keep in mind that the full investor pitch should support your elevator pitch - not contradict it or add new ideas. Keep your message consistent across all formats: elevator pitch, full pitch, deck, and follow-up materials.

Recommended structure:

1. Hook and Problem - describe ONE clear and urgent problem. Make it personal and concrete. Show the pain in time, money, or frustration. Use a real example from your user interviews.
   [For example: "*Last year, we spoke with over 40 small e-commerce founders. Almost all of them said they waste up to 15 hours a week copying order data between Shopify, Google Sheets, and email - just to keep their teams aligned. It slows down operations, causes mistakes, and makes it hard to grow.*"]

2. Solution and Live Demo - explain your unique approach. Focus on outcomes you deliver, not just features. Show why NOW is the right time. Highlight your unfair insight or advantage.
   [For example: "*We built a lightweight automation tool made just for e-commerce teams. It pulls order and shipping data from your platforms and sends it to the right Slack channels in real time. You can set it up in under five minutes with zero code.*

Unlike Zapier, we do not ask users to build automations themselves. We baked in templates based on the 20 most common workflows we saw during research. And it updates in real time, so your team always has the latest info without asking."]

3. Traction Proof - show your early traction - website visits, sign-ups, replies, conversions, pilots, or testimonials. Small numbers are just fine if they show real progress.
   [For example: "*In the last 6 weeks, we onboarded 12 teams. They are using our product for order tracking, team updates, and delivery alerts. Three of them have used it daily for over a month. One team says it saves them about five hours per week. We also got our first $99/month subscription.*"]

4. Market and Competitors - now talk about the opportunity size. Show market trends that support your timing. Explain your entry niche and how you can expand later. Map the main players. Explain how you are different and better for your niche. Remember: Saying “we have no competitors” is a huge red flag for investors. Keep this simple. Use round numbers and easy sources. Avoid complex charts. And most importantly - be honest!
   [For example: "*There are over 2 million small e-commerce teams globally. They are drowning in tools that do not talk to each other. The market for e-commerce operations software is over $30 billion and growing.*
   Our entry point is Shopify teams doing up to $500K per year. We do not compete directly with Zapier or Airtable. We offer focused, fast workflows built for non-technical founders."]

5. Business Model and Financials - explain how you make money. Make it simple: who pays, how much they pay, how often they pay. Then mention your main assumptions. For example: how many customers you expect to get, how fast you think you can grow, and what your main costs will be. Use your 12-month projection as a guide. You do not need perfect numbers - just show that your thinking is clear and realistic.
   [For example: "*We charge $99 per month per workspace. Our 12-month goal is to reach $15K MRR from 150 active teams. Costs are low — mostly cloud hosting and support. We can break even at around 300 teams.*"]

6. Team - next, tell why you and your team can pull this off. Mention relevant experience and skills. Share what you have already built together. Name the key hires you plan to make. Investors tend to remember the faces and the energy here.
   [For example: "*I am Alex, and I led ops for a Shopify brand that scaled to $2 million in two years. My co-founder, Dana, is a full-stack engineer who worked on*

B2B integrations at Zapier. We built our tool ourselves, and we have worked together on two shipping automation tools before."]

7. The Ask - and finally, state what you are raising. Explain what you will achieve with this capital. Give a rough timeline for raising and closing.
   At the end of your pitch, you can also mention any investors who are already supporting you. This helps show that others already believe in your project. It gives credibility and makes new investors more confident. It also shows that you have a structured plan for raising and growing.
   [For example: "*We are raising $250,000 to onboard 200 teams, build more templates, and test paid acquisition channels. We aim to close this round in 8 weeks.*
   So far, $50,000 is committed from one angel investor. We are also part of AltaLab, which provides support and structure during this raise and beyond."]

Write down your full investor pitch script below:

…

If you also want to attach your deck or any follow-up materials, feel free to do so. Upload them to your Google Drive and paste the links below. Please make sure the files are accessible via the links.